* This story was told to me by the journalist, soon after his lunch with Mr Natwar Singh.

* At the time, I lodged a formal complaint against this policy of restricted access. In a letter dated 26th April 2008 to the chairman of the NMML's Executive Council, Dr Karan Singh, I wrote: 'My own self-interest might lie in curbs being placed on these materials on Kashmir, China, the Emergency, *etc.* For then I could aspire to *India after Gandhi* becoming the authoritative and uncontested version of these events. However, I was trained by Ravinder Kumar to welcome disagreement. I deplore the fact that the access granted to me under a previous dispensation is now being denied to other and often younger scholars. For I wish them to explore, more fully and more rigorously than I could, the riches of the NMML, even if in so doing they were to challenge or overthrow my own explanations and arguments.'

* The signatories to the note were Sumit Sarkar, Neera Chandhoke, Madhavan Palat, Mahesh Rangarajan, Prabhu Mohapatra, Ramachandra Guha and Dilip Simeon.

* The letter was published in its entirety in the *Economic and Political Weekly*, issue dated June 27–July 4, 2009.

* The day after I wrote this paragraph, *The Hindu* published an article by Siddharth Varadarajan which compared the pogroms of 1984 and 2002 in the following words: 'The reality is that the Delhi and Gujarat massacres are part of the same excavated site, an integral part of the archaeology of the Indian state … In an act of conception which lasted four bloody days, something inhuman was spawned in the streets of Delhi in 1984; by 2002, it had fully matured. Paternity for the "riot system" belongs to both the Congress and the BJP, even if the sangh parivar managed to improve upon the technologies of mass violence. Both knew how to mobilise mobs. Both knew how to get the police to turn the other way. Both knew how to fix criminal cases. Both knew what language to speak, even if one set of leaders spoke of a "big tree falling"